

Top 5 Flows for New Google Data Studio Users

The first journeys every beginner needs, why they matter, and how to do them.

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01 Create your first report

Why it matters This is the core “aha” moment. Users who build one report early are far more likely to return.

1. Click **Create** → **Report**.
2. Pick a connector, select your data, click **Add** → **Add to report**.
3. Click **Untitled Report** to rename it. It saves automatically.

02 Connect and manage a data source

Why it matters Every chart depends on it. Wrong field types or stale credentials cause most “my numbers look wrong” tickets.

1. Click **Create** → **Data source**, then choose a connector (e.g. Google Sheets).
2. Select the file, click **Connect**.
3. Check each field’s data type and aggregation; click **Add a field** to create calculated fields.
4. Use **Refresh fields** when the source changes.

03 Start from a template

Why it matters Beginners face a blank canvas. Templates show good design and cut setup time.

1. Click **Templates** in the left menu.
2. Filter by category (e.g. Google Analytics, Sheets) and open one.
3. Click **Use my own data**, pick your data source, then click **Edit and share** to save it as your own report.

04 Add charts and interactive controls

Why it matters Filters and date ranges turn a static page into a dashboard viewers can explore.

1. In the editor, click **Add a chart** and choose a type; drag it onto the canvas.
2. In the **Setup** panel, set **Dimension** and **Metric**.
3. Click **Add a control** → **Date range control** or **Drop-down list**.
4. Click **View** to test it as a viewer.

05 Share and schedule a report

Why it matters Reports create value only when others see them. Scheduling keeps stakeholders updated without extra effort.

1. Click **Share** → add people and choose **Can view** or **Can edit** → **Send**.
2. Or open the **Share** drop-down → **Get report link** → **Copy link**.
3. From the same drop-down, choose **Schedule delivery**, set recipients and frequency, then click **Schedule**.